CONNECTED INTELLIGENCE

# YOUR TRUST CANOPY

Map how much you trust AI across every function.

Daniel Walters
Digitally Demented Ventures

MODULE 5 — PART B
Exercise Worksheet

# Module 5B — The Four Trust Levels

The Trust Canopy isn't a single setting — it's a per-function map. You might trust AI at Level 4 for formatting documents and Level 1 for client communication. Both are correct. The goal is intentional assignment, not uniform trust or uniform skepticism.

## The Four Levels

### Level 1 — Notify

AI observes and informs, but takes no action and produces no deliverable you use directly. You're aware AI could help, but you're not ready to hand it anything yet. You're still building confidence in the category.

**Example:** "AI flags that you haven't followed up with a contact in 30 days — you decide what to do." / "AI summarizes what a policy document says — you write the interpretation yourself."

### Level 2 — Suggest

AI produces a draft, recommendation, or analysis. You review every word before anything leaves your hands. High involvement, significant editing. You own the output as if you wrote it yourself.

**Example:** "AI drafts a client email — you rewrite 50–70% of it before sending." / "AI suggests a meeting agenda — you restructure it based on relationship context AI doesn't have."

### Level 3 — Act + Report

AI takes a defined action, then tells you what it did. You review after, not before. There's a clear audit trail. You're comfortable with occasional errors because recovery is easy and low-cost.

**Example:** "AI schedules a meeting based on your calendar rules and confirms after." / "AI reformats 50 rows of data and shows you the result." / "AI drafts social posts for a week — you review the batch on Friday."

### Level 4 — Autonomous

AI handles the full workflow with minimal to no review. You've established enough trust — through testing, verified outputs, and repeated success — that you've delegated the outcome, not just the task.

**Example:** "AI categorizes and labels all incoming emails automatically." / "AI generates and publishes formatted meeting notes to a shared drive after every call." / "AI reformats all uploaded documents to brand standard without review."

## How Trust Canopy Connects to the Rest of Your System

| Component | Connection to Trust Canopy |
|---|---|
| **G/Y/R Framework** | Green tasks are candidates for L3–L4. Yellow for L2–L3. Red tasks stay L1 — AI informs but doesn't act. |
| **Master Prompt** | Better context raises your trust ceiling. A strong Master Prompt is the prerequisite for moving from L2 to L3 on any writing task. |
| **Prompt Playbook** | Proven prompts enable trust escalation. When a prompt returns quality output 10 times in a row, you can raise the trust level and reduce review time. |
| **Tool Stack** | Trust level applies per tool, not just per function. You might trust Claude at L3 for proposals but ChatGPT only at L2 for the same task. |

> **Trust is earned, not assigned.** Don't jump from L1 to L4. Run a task at L2 until it consistently returns quality output. Then move to L3. The trust ladder is a testing protocol, not a permission slip.

# Module 5B — Trust Canopy: Example

This example shows a realistic trust map — including functions where the desired level is *lower* than current (deliberate pullback) and functions already at ceiling. Notice the gaps: they become your trust-building project list.

| Function | Current Level | Desired Level | Gap | Notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Email drafting | L2 — Suggest | L3 — Act+Report | +1 | Master Prompt in place. Ready to test batch drafts on low-stakes threads. |
| Meeting scheduling | L3 — Act+Report | L4 — Autonomous | +1 | Calendar rules defined. Need to test edge cases (double bookings, VIP contacts). |
| Research & synthesis | L3 — Act+Report | L3 — Act+Report | 0 | Already at right level. Research quality is high; don't need to change. |
| Content writing | L2 — Suggest | L2 — Suggest | 0 | Voice is too distinctive to fully delegate. L2 is the ceiling for branded content. |
| Data entry & formatting | L1 — Notify | L3 — Act+Report | +2 | Still manual. No prompt built. This is the biggest time waste in the stack. |
| Client communication | L1 — Notify | L2 — Suggest | +1 | Relationship risk keeps this at L2 max. AI drafts, I always own the send. |
| Social media | L2 — Suggest | L3 — Act+Report | +1 | Playbook prompt for LinkedIn is proven. Move to batch review + schedule. |
| Project planning | L1 — Notify | L2 — Suggest | +1 | AI good at structure; still need to own decisions and prioritization. |
| Document formatting | L4 — Autonomous | L4 — Autonomous | 0 | Fully automated. Template is locked. No review needed. |
| Brainstorming | L3 — Act+Report | L3 — Act+Report | 0 | AI generates options, I evaluate. Right balance of AI volume + human judgment. |

> **Reading the gaps:** Your largest gap is your highest-leverage trust-building target — not because it's urgent, but because the potential time savings is largest. Start there.

# Module 5B — Your Trust Canopy Map

Map your own functions. Be honest — not aspirational. Current level = what you're actually doing today. Desired level = where you want to be in 90 days, given your risk tolerance for that function.

| Function | Current Level | Desired Level | Gap | Notes / Blocker |
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# Module 5B — Your Trust Canopy Map (continued)

## Biggest Gap — Trust-Building Target

| Field | Your Answer |
|---|---|
| Function | |
| Current Level | |
| Desired Level | |
| What needs to happen to raise trust? | |
| Test plan (first 3 attempts) | |
| Target date to reassess | |

### Reflection Prompts

Where are you stuck at L1 not because of risk — but because you've never tried?

Which function at L2 is costing you the most time through repeated heavy editing?

Where is your trust level higher than it should be? What's the risk you're not accounting for?

90 days from now: which trust level change would have the biggest impact on your actual workload?